



**"EARLY TO BED AND
EARLY TO RISE MAKES
A MAN HEALTHY,
WEALTHY, AND WISE."**

Benjamin Franklin (1706-1790),
American politician

JET LAG

Flying long distances can cause havoc to your body clock. When this clock no longer matches the true time in your arrival destination, you can suffer from feelings of exhaustion and disorientation. This is known as jet lag. One way to get over it is to stay in bright light. As light enters your eyes, it triggers a signal to let your brain know that it is daytime, helping you resist the urge to go straight to sleep.



CREATURE COMFORTS

The animal kingdom has very different sleep patterns, and some are total opposites. While a giraffe needs only two hours sleep a day, a koala manages a whopping 22 hours of sleep. This is because its diet of eucalyptus leaves is nutritionally poor, so sleeping conserves precious energy.



THE BIG SLEEP

Food is scarce and temperatures plummet in the winter, so some animals go into a deep sleep called hibernation. They prepare by eating a lot in the fall, which allows them to live off their body fat, and constructing their winter nest, den, or burrow. Hibernation can last for weeks or months. During this time, the body's temperature lowers and breathing slows down. The animals emerge in the spring notably thinner but strong and ready to find food.

SLEEP DEPRIVATION

A lack of sleep makes people irritable, forgetful, and miserable. One night without sleep can result in a lack of concentration and a shorter attention span. If sleep deprivation continues, the area of the brain that controls language, memory, and planning virtually shuts down. Rats die sooner of sleep deprivation than starvation, and people are probably the same. It certainly can prove fatal—one in five highway accidents is blamed on sleep-deprived drivers.

